

GEOTECHNICAL INVESTIGATION REPORT

Flint Hills Geotechnical · Our reference FHG-2026-0520

INSTRUCTIONS

Instructed by:	Ozark Meridian Insurance Partners
On behalf of:	Cobalt Ridge Utility Contractors, LLC
Policy number:	
Author:	Anneliese Kowalczyk-Obi, PE, GE
Instructed by:	Cobalt Ridge Utility Contractors, LLC
Instructed on:	19 May 2026
Site attendance:	19 and 20 May 2026
Scope:	Cause of the wall failure and the safe condition of the excavation

WORKS, THIRD-PARTY PROPERTY AND PERSONS

Project:	City of Overland Park sanitary sewer rehabilitation
Contract:	OP-2026-SS-14, Cobalt Ridge as prime contractor to the City
Employees:	Two admitted with crush and compression injuries, one treated and released
Third party:	40 ft sidewalk, 30 ft kerb lane, 4 in gas service
Own plant:	Excavator tipped into the void, rented compressor, one vehicle

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Circumstances and findings

CIRCUMSTANCES

Circumstances:

An open cut excavation approximately fourteen feet deep and eight feet wide in a public right of way, replacing a 12-inch vitrified clay sanitary sewer under a City contract. A trench box protected the working section. The failure occurred in an extension beyond the box made to expose an unmarked service lateral.

FINDINGS

Findings:

The soil profile at the failure is a stiff lean clay to about seven feet over a medium dense silty sand, with a perched water table at nine feet six inches. The sand stratum classifies as Type C. The extension beyond the trench box was neither shored, sloped nor benched, and at fourteen feet in Type C material an unsupported vertical face is not stable under any condition. The competent person's daily inspection record for 19 May classifies the excavation as Type B, which the profile does not support. Sampling before backfill has been taken and photographed.

Date of loss:	19 May 2026
Cause of loss:	Excavation collapse — wall failure beyond the end of the trench box
Incident reference:	CRU-2026-IN-0033
Injuries reported:	3

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Preliminary quantum and reserve advice

PRELIMINARY QUANTUM

Basis:

The figures below are preliminary and are given for reserving purposes only. They are subject to verification and may move as the investigation continues.

Project rework, re-excavation and shoring	USD 250,000
Excavator recovery and repair:	USD 190,000
Rented compressor:	USD 38,000
Contractor vehicle:	USD 46,000
City roadway and sidewalk, range:	USD 240,000 to 400,000
Estimated loss:	1,150,000
Currency:	USD

ON THE SOIL CLASSIFICATION

Comment:

The classification recorded by the competent person is the central factual issue. A Type B classification permits a 1:1 slope; a Type C classification at this depth requires either a full-depth protective system or a 1.5:1 slope, neither of which was present in the extension. This is recorded as a finding of fact for the file.

RECOMMENDATION

Recommendation:

Do not re-open the excavation without a full-depth protective system designed for Type C material by a registered professional engineer.